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Education

University of Chicago, Ph.D. in Economics *2021–present*

University of Chicago, B.A. in Economics (Honors) and Mathematics *2015–2019*

References

Professor Azeem Shaikh (Co-Chair)
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Professor Alexander Torgovitsky (Co-Chair)
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Professor Kirill Ponomarev
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Research and Teaching Fields

Econometrics

Job Market Paper

Optimal Confidence Procedures for Partially Identified Parameters

Abstract: *I construct optimal confidence procedures in a flexible class of partially identified models. Under my decision-theoretic framework, reporting a confidence set incurs a loss equal to its excess length: the length of the part that does not overlap with the identified set. A confidence procedure is optimal if it minimizes worst-case expected excess length. I show that the problem of constructing such a procedure reduces to solving a single optimal testing problem and inverting the resulting test. This theoretical insight allows me to leverage recent computational advances in optimal testing to numerically approximate the optimal procedure. In a series of calibrated simulations, I quantify the suboptimality of existing inference techniques across a variety of empirical settings. Unlike the optimal procedure, methods with poor performance often direct power towards alternatives that are inconsistent with the model. I apply the optimal procedure to a recent event study design and find that it yields confidence sets that are 15 to 22 percent shorter than existing approaches.*

Working Papers

Distribution-Free Inference on Willingness-to-Pay in Binary Choice Experiments
(with Alexander Torgovitsky)

Abstract: *Choice experiments are widely used in a large number of fields, including a growing subfield of labor economics that measures the valuation of non-pecuniary workplace amenities. In contrast to many other types of randomized experiments, the evaluation of a choice experiment typically relies on parametric assumptions about the distribution of willingness-to-pay (WTP) for the choices, most commonly some flavor of logit or probit model. We develop distribution-free methods for inference in binary (dichotomous) choice experiments in which subjects choose from two options. Our methods are based on sharp characterizations of the identified set that are valid regardless of the variation in the data. We use our methods to re-evaluate the influential study by Mas and Pallais (2017) on the valuation for workplace amenities. Most of their conclusions survive without the logistic distributional assumption. The main exceptions are the valuation of overtime work, for which the experiment offered only two prices, as well as some gender differences, which our distribution-free methods suggest may be artifacts of the logit functional form.*

Quantifying Deterrence Effects in Judge Designs

Abstract: *To what extent can judges deter pretrial misconduct without detention? This question is becoming increasingly salient as jurisdictions across the United States enact bail reforms that make most people ineligible for monetary bail and pretrial detention. In this paper, I develop new econometric methods to learn about the deterrence effects of New York City's supervised release program, a de facto substitute for monetary bail following bail reform in New York State. I focus on identification and inference for a simple causal parameter: on average, how much does supervised release increase the court appearance rate of individuals with a given set of characteristics? I propose a parsimonious model of judge behavior that places intuitive restrictions on this parameter while allowing judges to have arbitrary private information. I demonstrate that under certain conditions, these restrictions still hold even if judges make decisions based on omitted payoffs or inaccurate beliefs. Finally, I present preliminary empirical results based on this model indicating that, on average, pretrial supervision increases court appearance rates by at least 2.9 but no more than 9.9 percentage points among the individuals in my sample.*

Work in Progress

Inference in Judge Designs with Multiple Margins of Treatment (with Yuehao Bai, Azeem Shaikh, and Ed Vytlacil)

Awards, Scholarships, and Grants

Becker Friedman Institute Public Economics Initiative Grant ($5,000)	*2024*
Lee Prize for Highest Score Earned on the Empirical Analysis Core Exam	*2022*
David S. Hu Award for Undergraduate Thesis in Economics	*2019*

Teaching Experience

Econometrics II - Honors (undergraduate)	TA for Prof. Torgovitsky	*Spring 2024*
Empirical Analysis I (graduate)	TA for Prof. Shaikh	*Fall 2023*
Topics in Modern Econometrics (graduate)	TA for Prof. Shaikh	*Spring 2023*
Machine Learning for Economists (graduate)	TA for Prof. Ponomarev	*Winter 2023*

Research Experience and Other Employment

Summer Intern, Microsoft Research New England *2025*

Pre-Doctoral Fellow for Prof. Greenstone, University of Chicago *2019–2021*

Professional Experience

Machine Learning in Economics Summer Institute Participant, University of Chicago *2022*

Presentations *Econometrics Working Group, University of Chicago*

Refereeing Activity *Journal of Political Economy*

Additional Information

Citizenship USA

Programming Skills Python, R

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